The Adventures of Three Brothers



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This story is dedicated to my three sons,
John, Stephen and Matthew,
in memory of bedtime stories in our tent during
our Colorado summer camping trips.



In a land not too far away live three brothers. Their names are Stephen, John and Matthew.



The three brothers like to do many of the same things that other children do. They climb rocks.



They read books.



And they eat cookies with milk.



When they put their magic capes on,



each of the three brothers has a special superpower.



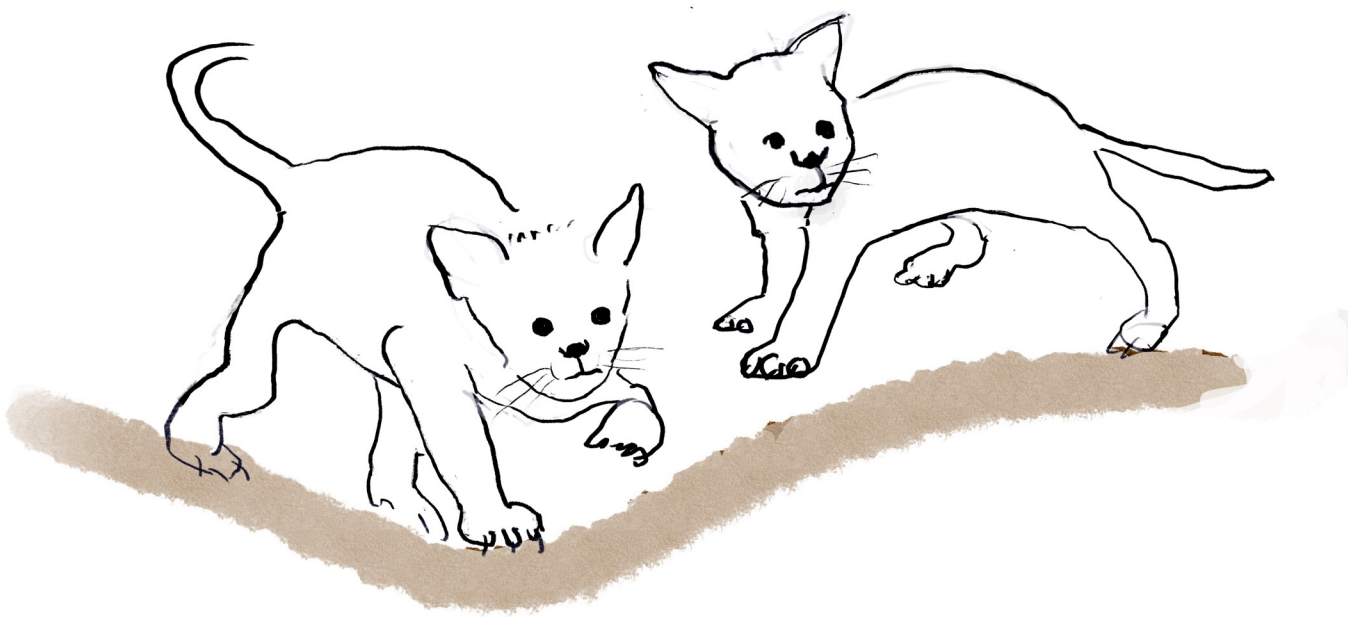
John can transform into any animal and acquire all of the animal's abilities.



Stephen can tame the wild and heal the wounded with his hands.



Matthew can travel anywhere in the universe. This special power is called teleportation.



One day, the three brothers learned something that made them feel sad. Two lion cubs were lost in the high mountains of Arizona and their mother could not find them.



“We need to help them,” said Stephen. “Let’s put on our magic capes.”



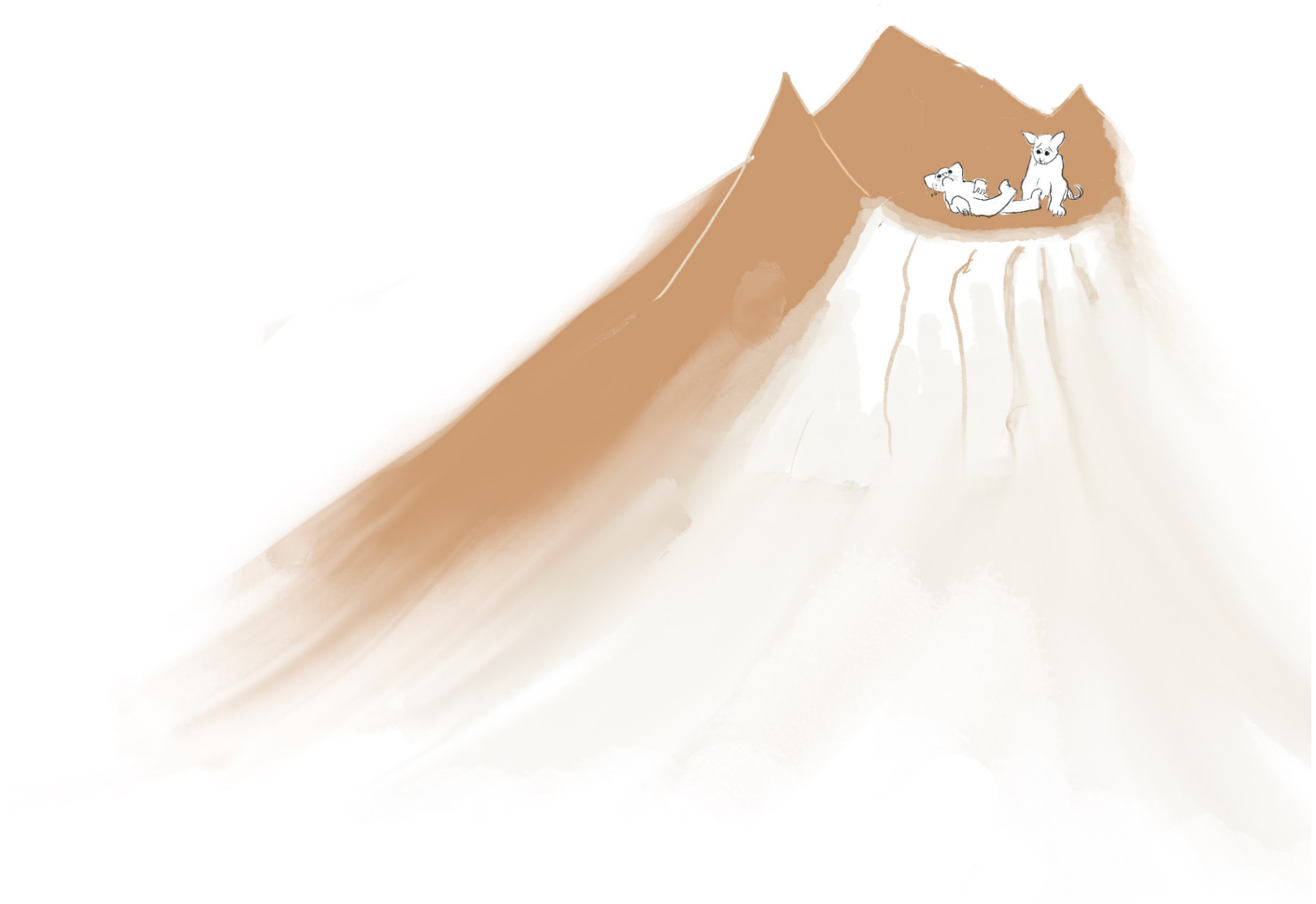
“Hold onto my arms,” said Matthew, “and I will teleport us to the high mountains where we will look for the two lion cubs.”



And so they did.



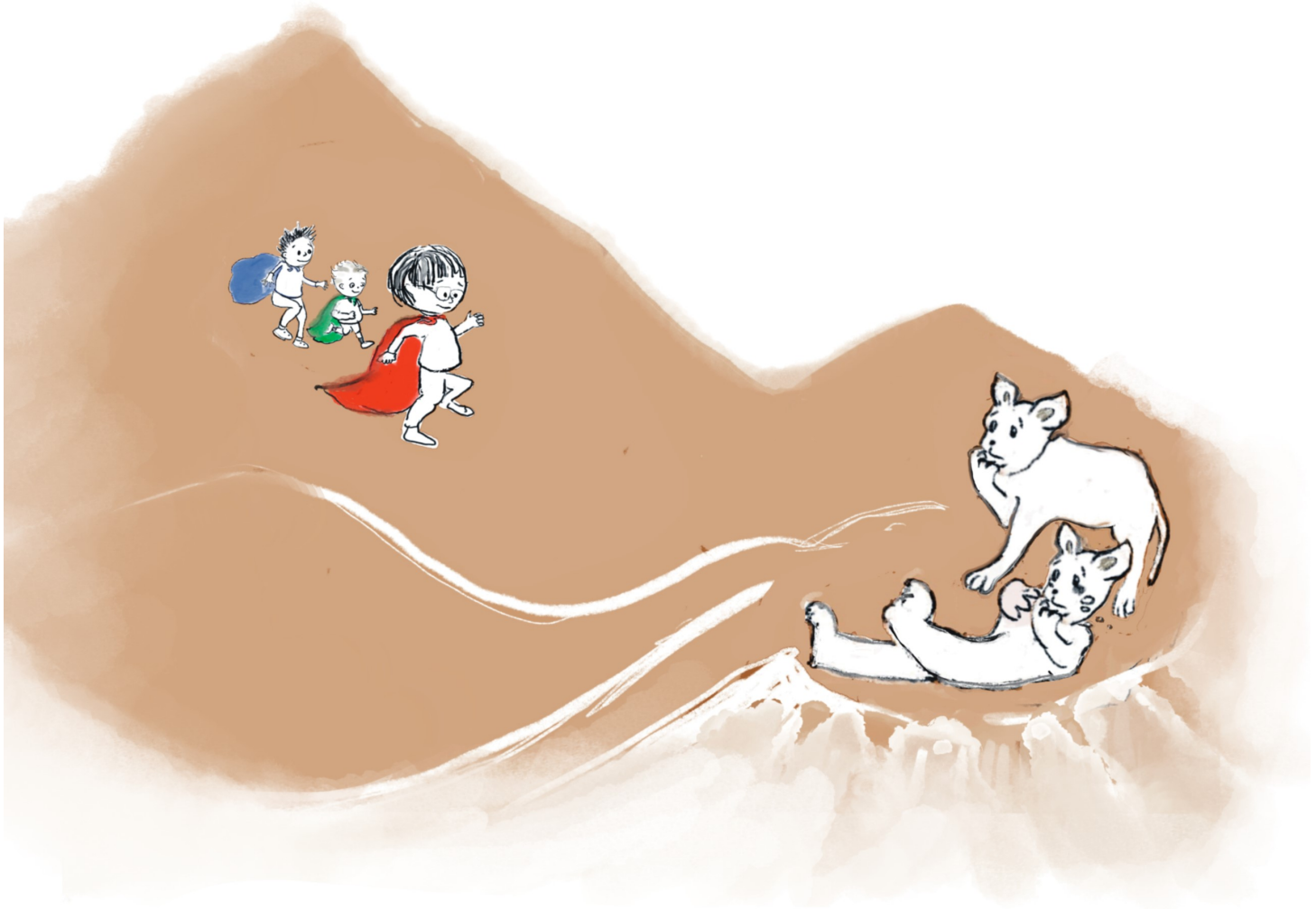
Flying high over the mountains, it was hard to see the ground. John said, "I will transform into an eagle with super X-ray vision." And so he did.



“There!” shouted John. “I see them! The lion cubs are trapped on the edge of a steep cliff!”



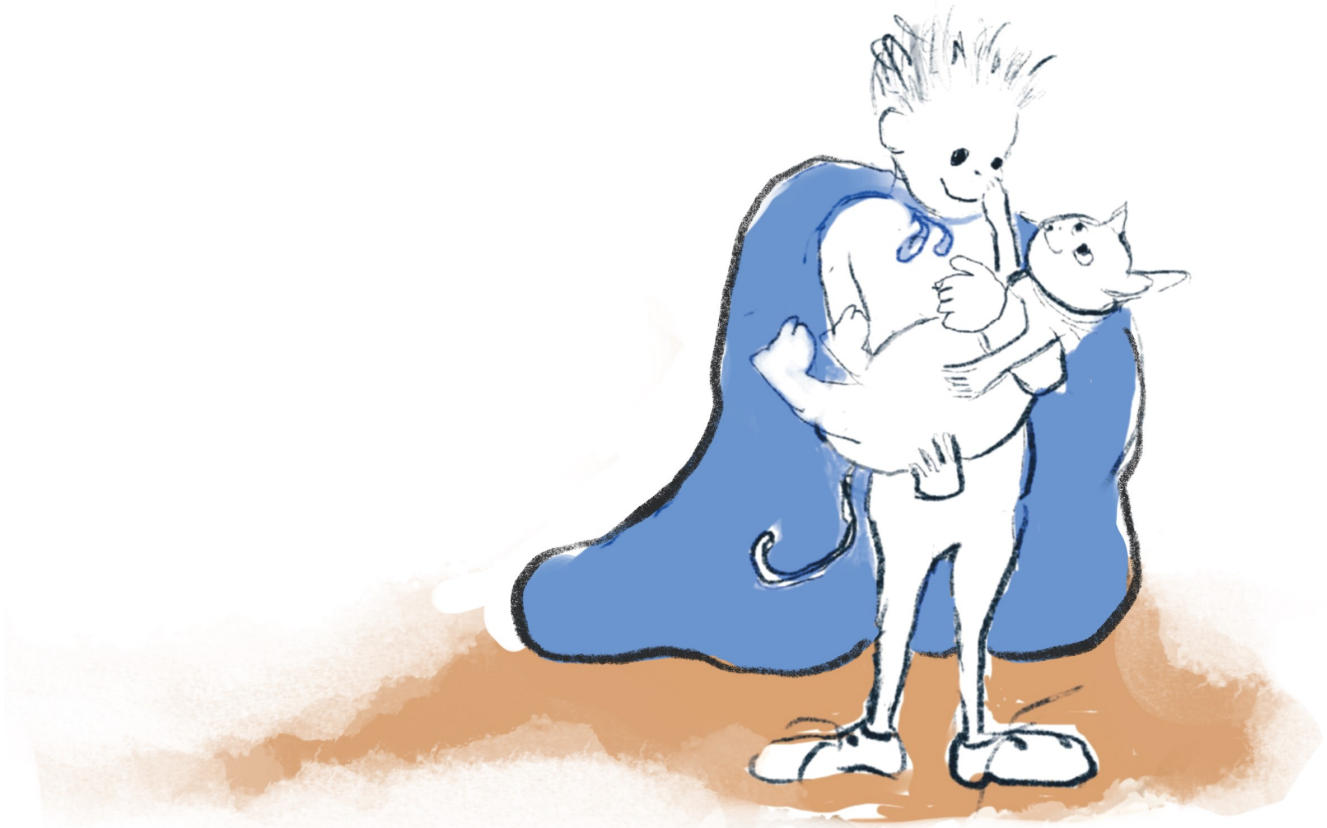
The three brothers soared to the cliff's edge. They could see that one of the lion cubs had a broken leg.



When the lion cubs saw the three brothers wearing capes, they were frightened. John said, "I will change into a mother lion so the cubs won't be afraid of us."



John transformed into a mother lion and softly crept toward the two cubs. One of the cubs ran eagerly to him, licking and meowing with delight. The lion cub with the broken leg lay on the ground crying.



Stephen said, "I will heal the lion cub with the touch of my healing hands." Stephen gently picked up the crying cub and stroked the broken leg until it healed. The lion cub purred happily and patted Stephen's face.



“Now we must find their mother,” said Matthew.



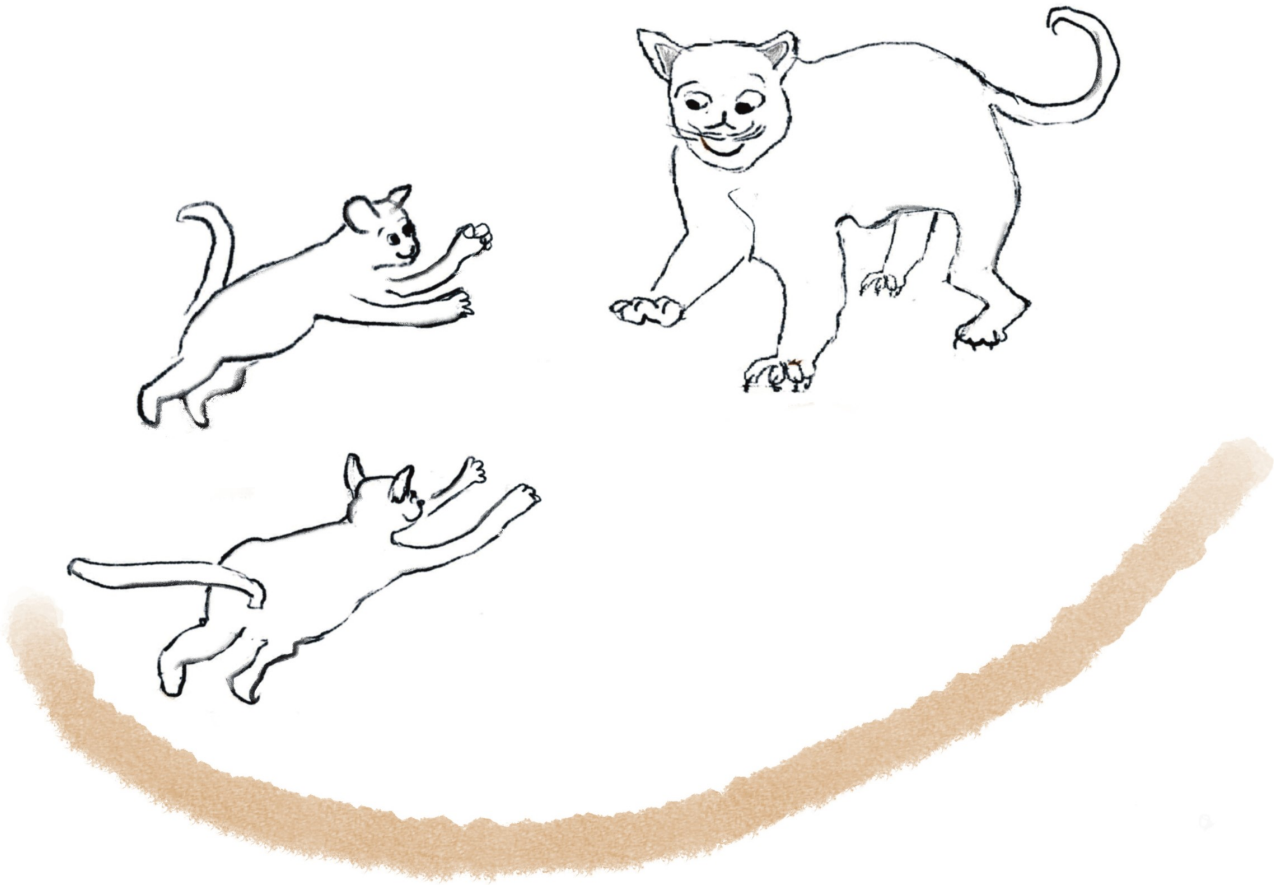
John transformed again into an eagle with X-ray vision. Soaring over the mountains, John saw the den where the mother lion lived.



John and Stephen each tenderly cradled a lion cub with one hand while holding onto Matthew with the other. Matthew reached his arms toward the sky and up they flew, the three brothers and the two lion cubs, until they found the lion mother.



Stephen approached first, holding out his healing hands to calm the fierce mother lion. “Do not fear us,” Stephen said. “We have found your two lost cubs.”



The brothers carefully released the cubs on the grass. The two lion cubs scampered to their mother with joy. Their mother scolded them for running off while also licking them because they were safely home and she was happy.



The mother lion bowed deeply to the three brothers to show her gratitude.
The three brothers also bowed and said good-bye to the lion family.



John and Stephen gripped Matthew's arms and he teleported them all home.



Their mother was happy to see them and gave them a snack of cookies with milk.





The End

